

BANGARUSWAMI
SOUNDARAJAN

44, POULTRY FARMER
MD, SUGUNA POULTRY
TURNOVER IN 1997 Rs 7 crore
CURRENT TURNOVER Rs 3,000 crore

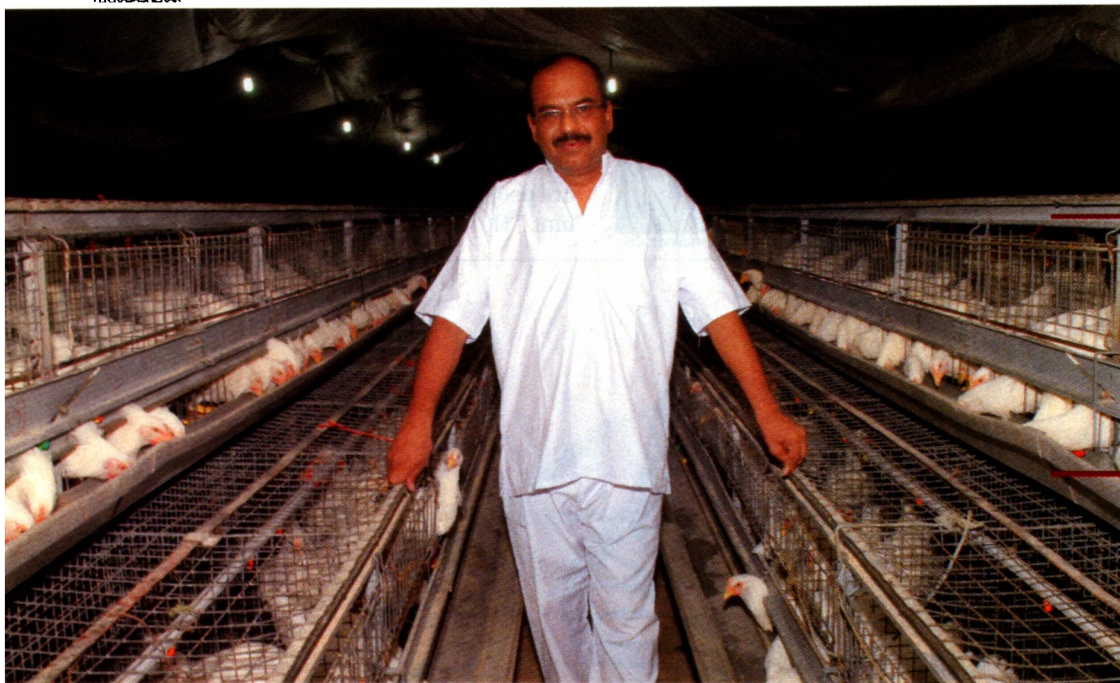
SQUAWK AND AWE

For this son of schoolteacher parents, it's almost blasphemy to undermine the value of education and attribute his success to attitude. But then, Bangaruswami Soundarajan, the managing director of the Rs 3,000-crore Suguna Poultry Farm, has always taken the road less travelled. Born in a village near Udumalpet, 130 km from Coimbatore, Soundarajan decided to do business immediately after completing school.

West Bengal respectively," says Soundarajan.

The turning point came in 1997, when Soundarajan decided to introduce innovative contract farming for the first time in the country and within a year, the company managed to record a turnover of Rs 7 crore. Suguna invests by helping farmers in the daily management of the chicks. Its employees closely monitor the growth of the birds and provide farmers with feed and free medicines.

H.K. RAJASHEKAR



success MANTRA

Fairness, transparency
and an ethical working style
is the key to making it

biggest ACHIEVEMENT

Suguna is a leading
integrator of poultry
products in India today

growth PATH

Suguna has a presence
in 12 states with a network
of 15,000 farmers

In 1990, with an initial investment of Rs 5,000, he followed his dream by setting up a poultry farm. What started as a small-scale venture today has grown to become a leading integrator of poultry products in the country with an increasing global presence. For Soundarajan, his biggest achievement has been the acceptance and appreciation of his management skills by people outside his state. "On realising that poultry can give regular incomes to farmers, even in droughts, N. Chandrababu Naidu and Buddhadeb Bhattacharya invited me to invest in Andhra Pradesh and

Today, his poultry business has a presence in 12 states and provides assistance to around 15,000 farmers nationwide. For Soundarajan, management has been the key to success. In 2000, he introduced professional management in the company to augment growth. Recently, Suguna implemented a Rs 9-crore Enterprise Resource Planning solution supported by Oracle. "This will help us in setting up a robust information system to support our current growth," says Soundarajan. Indeed, for the 44-year-old managing director, the dream has hatched. *by Banumathi Krishnaswamy*

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